LO-FI HOLIDAY BEAT

Pacing guide · 4 class periods

PACING

Teacher

4 class periods. The “Plan” column is the day-by-day pacing; the other columns show what to put on the screen and in students’ hands.

CLASS	PLAN	TEACHER MOVES	DECK	STUDENT PAGES
CLASS 1	Choose a carol, fill in the Beat plan, and enter the melody and chords.	Slides 1–6: the hook, what the project is, the four classes, the five moves and how to read a piano roll. Hand out the project sheet, the three charts and the Beat plan. Check that each student has a carol and a tempo before they leave.	Slides 1–6	p. 12, p. 13, p. 14, p. 18, p. 20, p. 21, p. 22, p. 24
CLASS 2	Build the beat: drums, swing and a bass line.	Slides 7–9: building the beat, straight against swung, and three lo-fi drum patterns. Demonstrate the Step Sequencer and Q-Swing on the projector, then work time. Walk the room with one question: is it lazy yet?	Slides 7–9	p. 15
CLASS 3	Make it lo-fi, plan the form, and build the arrangement and mix.	Slides 10–11: the worked example on paper and the four sound moves. Hand out the Arrangement plan. Then work time; ask each student to play their first 20 seconds and say which carol they hear.	Slides 10–11	p. 16, p. 17, p. 19
CLASS 4	Bounce, hand in, present and reflect.	Slides 12–15: what to turn in, the rubric, presentation day and the close. Students bounce, name their files and write their three feedback questions, then present. Reflection (page 26) follows the presentations.	Slides 12–15	p. 23, p. 25, p. 26

THE ONE THING TO DO ON CLASS 1

Make sure every student leaves with a carol, a tempo from 70 to 90 BPM and four chords written on the Beat plan. If the tempo is only a guess, tap it: tap a steady beat for ten seconds and count the taps.

IF YOU ONLY HAVE THREE CLASSES

Merge Classes 2 and 3: build the beat and add the lo-fi effects on Class 2, then arrange and mix on Class 3 and use Class 4 for bouncing, presentations and reflection.

PREVIEW

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LO-FI HOLIDAY BEAT

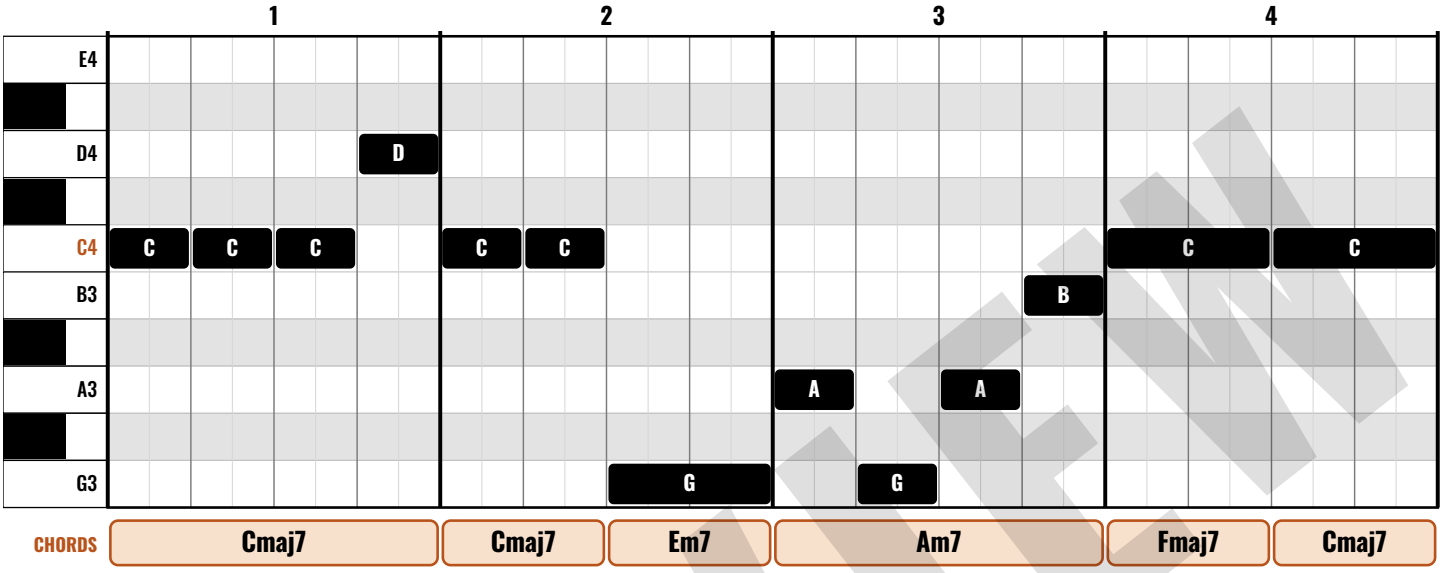
STUDENT

Note chart · Good King Wenceslas

Class 1

Name _____ Date _____

Good King Wenceslas, the first phrase · melody “Tempus adest floridum”, 1582 · C major, 4/4 · 4 bars · 13 notes

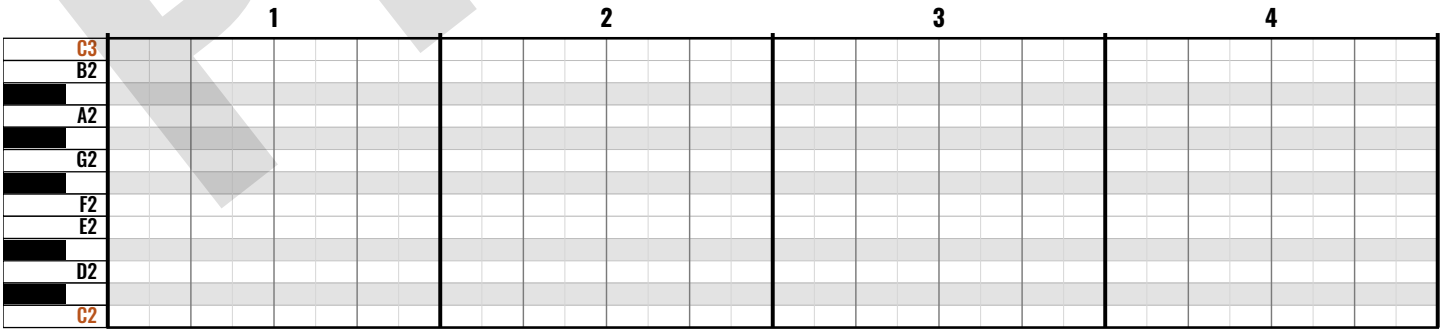


BAR	NOTES (PITCH, LENGTH)	CHORDS
1	C4 quarter · C4 quarter · C4 quarter · D4 quarter	Cmaj7
2	C4 quarter · C4 quarter · G3 half	Cmaj7 · Em7
3	A3 quarter · G3 quarter · A3 quarter · B3 quarter	Am7
4	C4 half · C4 half	Fmaj7 · Cmaj7

ABOUT THIS CHART

A 13th-century spring carol, first published in the Finnish collection Piae Cantiones in 1582. The English words (1853) are not used. Bar 1 is C C C D; bar 4 is two long Cs, so the loop breathes before it starts again. Loop all four bars. Chords shown are one idea that fits; try others by ear. Drums: pattern A, B or C (page 15).

YOUR TURN: WRITE A BASS LINE ON THE CHORD ROOTS (PENCIL), ONE LONG NOTE PER CHORD



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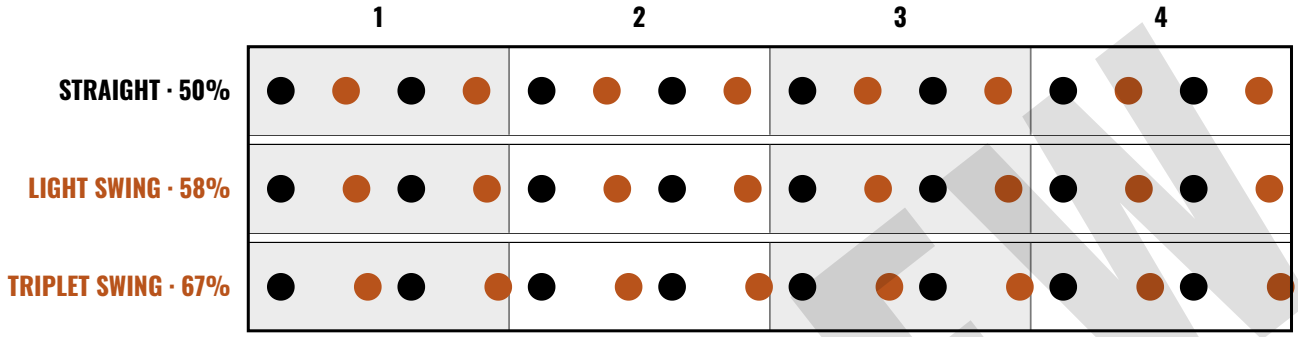
Lo-fi effect cards · 1 of 2

STUDENT

Class 3

Five small moves make a beat sound lo-fi: swing, tape, a Bitcrusher, a low-pass filter and vinyl noise. Use at least four. This page has swing and tape; page 17 has the other three. Every move should be small enough that the carol is still easy to hear.

SWING · MAKE THE BEAT BOUNCE



At 80 BPM a 16th note lasts 187.5 ms: light swing is 30 ms late, triplet swing 62.5 ms late

What it does. Moves the off-beat 16th notes a little later, so a steady pattern rolls and bounces instead of marching. More swing, more bounce.

In Logic. Select the MIDI region. In the Region inspector, set Quantize to a 1/16-note value, then raise Q-Swing. Try the hats first.

Try. Light swing on the hats, a little less on the kick and snare. Q-Swing is Logic's own scale, so use the diagram as a guide and decide by ear.

Listen for. The pattern leans back instead of marching. If it sounds loose or sloppy, you have too much.

TAPE · WOBBLE, WARMTH AND ECHO

What it does. Old tape drifts a little in pitch, softens the highs and adds warm distortion and echo. A touch of all of that makes a digital sound feel played from a tape.

In Logic. Put Scanner Vibrato or a light Chorus on the keys for a slow, small wobble. Add Tape Delay with low feedback for a soft echo. For warmth use ChromaGlow if your version has it; if not, turn Overdrive down to a tiny amount.

Try. Keep the wobble depth low: the pitch should drift, not warble. Set the delay to an eighth note and the mix low.

Listen for. A slightly seasick warmth. If the chords sound out of tune, back the depth off.

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LO-FI HOLIDAY BEAT

Rubric

RUBRIC

/ 25

Name _____ Date _____

GRADING RUBRIC /25

Lo-Fi Holiday Beat | Original Project

Each category is scored 1–5. Score yourself first; your final grade is the average of your self-score and your teacher's score.

Category	1	2	3	4	5
MELODY & CHORDS	The melody is missing or mostly wrong	Several wrong pitches or lengths; chords missing or clashing	Mostly right, with a few slips; chords fit most of the loop	Every pitch and length matches the chart; the chords fit	Exact, with chords and a bass line that support the melody; the carol is unmistakable
LO-FI BEAT	No clear drum pattern or tempo	A drum pattern, but stiff, or outside 70 to 90 BPM	A steady drum pattern in range, with some swing	A swung pattern with kick, snare and hats that fit the tempo	A relaxed, bouncing groove: swing, drums and bass lock together
LO-FI SOUND	No lo-fi effects	One or two effects, hard to hear or overdone	Four lo-fi moves used, each audible	Four or five moves, balanced, and the student can say what each does	Every effect is used on purpose, with automation, and the carol is still clear
ARRANGEMENT & MIX	No clear form; layers cover each other	A loop with little change; muddy mix	Intro, beat sections and outro; mostly balanced	Clear form with a break; layers enter and leave; clean mix	A form that builds and resolves; every layer audible, melody on top, noise quiet
PLAN & REFLECTION	Plans, presentation or reflection missing	Thin plan; little to say about choices	Plan and reflection complete, with basic detail	Clear plan; thoughtful reflection and good answers to questions	Insightful reflection and a polished, confident presentation

Student Score: _____ / 25	Teacher Score: _____ / 25
Final Grade = Average of Student + Teacher = _____ / 25	

PREVIEW

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